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Research Areas

Interpersonal political communication; emotions and behavior; deliberation; celebrity politics; digital communication.

Teaching Focus

Communication theory; communication methods; professional and business communication; intercultural communication; journalism and public relations; media literacy; political communication.

Education

Texas Tech University — Lubbock, TX, USA
Ph.D., Media and Communication — Spring 2027 (expected)
Minor: Political Psychology
Advisor: Bryan McLaughlin

Federal University of Minas Gerais — Belo Horizonte, MG, Brazil
M.A., Social Communication — 2023
Minor: Communicative Processes and Social Practices
Advisor: Paula Simoes

B.A., Journalism — 2021
Advisor: Regiane Lucas Garcez

Academic Appointments

Texas Tech University, College of Media & Communication — 2023-present
Graduate Part-Time Instructor & Research Assistant

	Federal University of Minas Gerais, College of Philosophy and Human Sciences Graduate Teaching Assistant & Research Assistant	2017-2023

Awards and Funding

Fulbright Foreign Student Award U.S. Department of State & The Ministry of Education of Brazil	2022-2026
C.R. Hutcheson Endowed Graduate Fellowship Texas Tech University	2024-2026
CH Foundation Graduate Fellowship The CH Foundation & Texas Tech University	2023-2026
Helen DeVitt Jones Graduate Fellowship Texas Tech University	2023-2026
College of Media & Communication Graduate Fellowship Texas Tech University	2023-2026
Thomas Jay Harris Endowed Graduate Fellowship Thomas Jay Harris Institute for Hispanic and International Communication	2023-2024
The Institute for Advanced Transdisciplinary Studies Teaching Fellowship Federal University of Minas Gerais	2022
Master's Fellowship Federal Agency for Support and Evaluation of Graduate Education of Brazil	2021-2023
Research Assistantship National Council for Scientific and Technological Development of Brazil	2018-2019
Research Assistantship Foundation for Research and Development of the State of Minas Gerais	2017-2018

Peer-reviewed Papers

2 McLaughlin, B., Geiger, N., & **Rocha, P. H. P.** (2025). A waste of Time? Partisan Deliberative Bias as a Barrier to Political Crosstalk. *Political Behavior*. https://doi.org/rq22

1 **Rocha, P. H. P.** & Simoes, P. G. (2021). "A celebridade é política? Movimentos de politização e despolitização entre Anitta e seus públicos" [Is the celebrity political? Movements of politicisation and

depoliticisation between the Brazilian singer Anitta and her publics]. *Revista Eco-Pós*, 24(2), 201–225. https://doi.org/rq23

Manuscripts in Progress

Rocha, P. H. P. & McLaughlin, B. (under review). Feeling It Before It Happens: The Influence of Affective Forecasting on Willingness to Engage in Political Talk. *Group Processes & Intergroup Relations*.

Book Chapters

4 **Paixao-Rocha, P.** & Garcez, R. L. (2024). Celebrity activism as discursive representation: A case study of the Brazilian singer Daniela Mercury and LGBTQ rights in Brazil. In G. Ouvrein, A. Jorge & H. Van den Buck (Eds.), *Audience Interactions in Contemporary Celebrity Culture: Approaches from across Disciplines*, 69–91. Lexington Books.

3 **Paixão, P.** (2020). "As políticas de Anitta" [The politics of Anitta]. In V. França, P. Simões, T. Silva, F. Souza, & S. Silveira (Eds.), *Diário da Quarentena: A pandemia de Covid-19 como acontecimento*, 367–370. Selo PPGCOM UFMG.

2 **Paixão, P.** (2020). "Celebridades em tempos de Covid-19" [Celebrities in times of Covid-19]. In V. França, P. Simões, T. Silva, F. Souza, & S. Silveira (Eds.), *Diário da Quarentena: A pandemia de Covid-19 como acontecimento*, 173–178. Selo PPGCOM UFMG.

1 Brandão, V. C., **Rocha, P. H. P.**, Carvalho, B. G., & Cançado, C. L. (2019). "A mobilização afetiva do saber: literatura como mediação da experiência do conhecimento" [The affective mobilization of knowledge: Literature as a mediation of the experience of knowing]. In S. C. Pessoa, Â. S. Marques, & C. M. C. Mendonça (Eds.), *Afetos: Pesquisas, reflexões e experiências em encontros com Jean-Luc Moriceau*, 97–112. Selo PPGCOM UFMG.

Conference Presentations

6 **Rocha, P. H. P.** & McLaughlin, B. (2026). *Feeling It Before It Happens: The Influence of Affective Forecasting on Willingness to Engage in Political Talk.* 2026 Association for Education in Journalism and Mass Communication (AEJMC) Annual Conference. New Orleans, LA (poster).

5 **Rocha, P. H. P.** (2024). *The Politics of Anitta: (De)Politicization of Celebrities and Celebritization of Brazilian Politics.* 17th Congress of the Brazilian Studies Association (BRASA). San Diego, CA (paper).

4 **Rocha, P. H. P.** & Garcez, R. L. (2021). *Política de celebridades como representação política não-eleitoral: um estudo de caso sobre Daniela Mercury e seus públicos* [Celebrity politics as non-electoral political representation: A case study of Daniela Mercury and her publics]. 9th Conference of the Brazilian Political Communication Association. Belo Horizonte, Brazil (paper).

3 **Rocha, P. H. P.** & Simoes, P. (2019). *Is the Artist Political? Politicization Dynamics Between Celebrities and Their Audiences*. 4th Brazilian Conference of Communication Studies. Pocos de Caldas, Brazil (paper).

2 **Rocha, P. H. P.** & Simoes, P. (2018). *De #AnittaDigaNãoAoFascismo a #AnittaIsOverParty: disputa de posicionamentos e valores nas interações entre públicos e celebridades* [From #AnittaSayNoToFascism to #AnittaIsOverParty: Disputes over stances and values in interactions between publics and celebrities]. 28th Undergraduate Research Week at the Federal University of Minas Gerais. Belo Horizonte, Brazil (poster).

1 **Rocha, P. H. P.** & Garcez, R. L. (2017). *Representação política não-eleitoral: Beyoncé e o movimento negro norte-americano* [Non-electoral political representation: Beyoncé and the U.S. Black movement]. 26th Undergraduate Research Week at the Federal University of Minas Gerais. Belo Horizonte, Brazil (poster).

Teaching Experience

Texas Tech University, College of Media & Communication

Fall 2026	MCOM 3300: Theories of Media and Communication
	PCOM 3373: Applied Workplace Communication
Spring 2026	PCOM 4373: Digital Media and Professional Communication Capstone
Fall 2025	PCOM 3373: Applied Workplace Communication
Summer 2025	PCOM 3373: Applied Workplace Communication
	PRSC 4351: International and Multicultural Public Relations
Spring 2025	MCOM 2350: Communicating in a Global Society
Fall 2024	PCOM 3373: Applied Workplace Communication

Summer 2024	MCOM 2330: Media Literacy
Spring 2024	MCOM 2310: Business and Professional Communication
Fall 2023	MCOM 2350: Communicating in a Global Society *Teaching assistant to Dr. Sarah Schiffecker*

Federal University of Minas Gerais, College of Philosophy and Human Sciences

2022	COM 323: Projetos C em Jornalismo (Journalism Capstone)
2021	COM 319: Projetos B II em Jornalismo (Journalism Projects)
2021	COM 087: Tópicos em Comunicação Social: Crise da Democracia (Special Topics in Communication: The Crisis of Democracy) *Teaching assistant to Dr. Rousiley Maia*
2020	COM 055: Comunicação e Política (Political Communication) *Teaching assistant to Dr. Camilo Aggio*

Student Supervision

Thesis, advisor – Federal University of Minas Gerais

Gabriel Soares de Souza, B.A. in Journalism

Thesis title: "Foi longe demais? A construção da imagem pública de Pabllo Vittar e a celebrização da cultura drag queen em espaços midiáticos" [Did it go too far? The construction of Pabllo Vittar's public image and the celebritization of drag culture in media spaces].

Thesis, committee member - Federal University of Minas Gerais

Iago Cunha Lage, B.A. in Advertising
Beatriz Ribeiro Costa, B.A. in Journalism
Diogo Jose Diniz, B.A. in Journalism

Service

Organizing committee member

2023	4th Meeting of the Interinstitutional Network on Events and Public Figures

2021	9th Conference of the Brazilian Political Communication Association
2020	Pint of Science Brazil
2019	2nd Meeting of the Interinstitutional Network on Events and Public Figures
2018	1st Meeting of the Interinstitutional Network on Events and Public Figures

University Outreach

2018–2022	Laboratório de Análise de Acontecimentos [Laboratory of Event Analysis], UFMG Research Group of Image and Sociability
2018	Training Program for Cultural Producers and Communicators, UFMG Office of Cultural Affairs
2016–2017	Internal Communication Program, UFMG School of Physical Education, Physiotherapy and Occupational Therapy

Professional Experience

2022	**Workers' Party of Brazil (PT)** Copywriter
2021–2022	**UFMG Press** Marketing Specialist
2021–2022	**Citizen Initiatives Agency (AIC)** Communications Analyst
2020–2021	**Research Development Foundation (Fundep)** Marketing Intern
2019–2020	**Association of UFMG Professors (Apubh UFMG)** Communications Intern
2018–2019	**Regional Council of Engineering and Agronomy of Minas Gerais (CREA-MG)** Communications Intern
2018	**UFMG Office of Cultural Affairs (DAC UFMG)** Communications Intern
2016–2017	**UFMG School of Physical Education, Physiotherapy and Occupational Therapy (EEFFTO)** Communications Intern

Media Appearances

4 "Pesquisador do Gris UFMG reflete sobre a atuação política de celebridades dentro e fora das eleições" [Gris UFMG researcher reflects about the political role of celebrities in and outside elections]. Radio UFMG Educativa, 2022.

3 "Por que o BBB faz tanto sucesso, segundo pesquisadores" [Why is *Big Brother Brazil* so popular, according to researchers]. Exame Magazine, 2021.

2 "Mesa-redonda: cultura do cancelamento" [Roundtable: Cancel Culture]. Rede Minas, 2020.

1 "Preconceito contra homens gays 'afeminados' é estudado na UFMG" [Prejudice against effeminate gay men studied at UFMG]. TV UFMG, 2018.

Professional Associations

Association for Education in Journalism and Mass Communication (AEJMC)
National Communication Association (NCA)
International Communication Association (ICA)
Brazilian Political Communication Association (Compolítica)
Brazilian Association of Graduate Programs in Communication (Compós)

Technical Skills

Programming languages: R; Python.
Data analysis and visualization: RStudio; SPSS; Tableau; Gephi.
Qualitative analysis: ATLAS.ti; NVivo.
Methods: survey, experiment, content analysis, network analysis, textual analysis, focus group, interview.

Languages

Portuguese (native)
English (fluent)
French (advanced)